

1 ENGROSSED SENATE
2 BILL NO. 1338

By: Pugh and Hicks of the
Senate

3 and

4 Caldwell (Chad) and
5 Hasenbeck of the House

6
7 An Act relating to the Strong Readers Act; amending
8 Section 2, Chapter 288, O.S.L. 2023, as amended by
9 Section 9, Chapter 411, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp.
10 2025, Section 1210.508H), which relates to literacy
11 instructional team; removing language establishing
12 three-year pilot program; prohibiting certain school
districts that decline certain assistance from being
eligible for certain funds; requiring biennial
submission of certain report; updating contents of
report; updating statutory language; providing an
effective date; and declaring an emergency.

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15 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

16 SECTION 1. AMENDATORY Section 2, Chapter 288, O.S.L.
17 2023, as amended by Section 9, Chapter 411, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S.
18 Supp. 2025, Section 1210.508H), is amended to read as follows:

19 Section 1210.508H. A. Beginning with the 2023-2024 school
20 year, the State Department of Education shall ~~establish a three-year~~
21 ~~pilot program to~~ employ a literacy instructional team to support
22 school districts in implementation of the requirements of Section
23 1210.508C of this title. The Department shall provide technical
24 assistance for literacy instruction, dyslexia, and related

1 disorders, and serve as a primary source of information and support
2 for schools in addressing the needs of students struggling with
3 literacy, dyslexia, and related disorders.

4 B. The Department shall employ a literacy instructional team
5 with team members who are placed regionally across the state. The
6 literacy instructional ~~teams~~ team members shall assist general
7 education and special education teachers in recognizing educational
8 needs to improve literacy outcomes for all students including those
9 with dyslexia or identified with the risk characteristics associated
10 with dyslexia. The role of the literacy instructional team shall
11 also include increasing professional awareness and instructional
12 competencies to meet the educational needs of all students including
13 those with dyslexia or identified with risk characteristics
14 associated with dyslexia. The Department shall prioritize supports
15 and interventions including enrollment in reading trainings and
16 professional development for schools which have the highest
17 percentage of students who do not demonstrate sufficient reading
18 skills as established by the State Board of Education. If a school
19 district that is prioritized for supports and interventions pursuant
20 to this subsection declines to accept assistance from a literacy
21 instructional team, the district shall not be eligible to receive
22 funds pursuant to Section 1210.508D of this title.

23 C. Literacy instructional team members employed by the
24 Department shall have training in:

1 1. The science of how students learn to read including
2 phonological awareness, phonics, fluency, vocabulary, comprehension,
3 writing, and language;

4 2. Foundation of multisensory, explicit, systematic, and
5 structured reading instruction;

6 3. Identification of and the appropriate interventions,
7 accommodations, and teaching techniques for struggling students;

8 4. The requirements of the Strong Readers Act;

9 5. Special education laws and procedures; and

10 6. Appropriate interventions, accommodations, and assistive
11 technology supports for students with dyslexia or a related
12 disorder.

13 D. The literacy instructional team members employed by the
14 Department shall report to the Program Director for Literacy at the
15 Department and have:

16 1. A minimum of five regional literacy leads, including at
17 least one who shall be designated by the Department as a dyslexia
18 specialist to provide school districts with support and resources
19 that are necessary to assist students with dyslexia. The Department
20 shall give preference to educators applying for regional literacy
21 lead who:

22 a. have an endorsement or certification as a certified
23 structured literacy dyslexia specialist or certified
24 academic language therapist,

- b. are knowledgeable of multitiered systems of support,
and
- c. have been trained in the identification of and
intervention for dyslexia and related disorders
including best practice interventions and treatment
models for dyslexia; and

2. A minimum of ten literacy specialists. The Department shall give preference to educators applying for literacy specialist who:

- a. have training in the science of reading,
- b. are knowledgeable of multitiered systems of support,
and
- c. have been trained in the identification of and
intervention for dyslexia and related disorders
including best practice interventions and treatment
models for dyslexia.

E. The State Department of Education shall electronically submit a report to the Governor, the President Pro Tempore of the Senate, and the Speaker of the House of Representatives by December 31, 2026, and by December 31 biennially thereafter, that includes an evaluation of ~~the pilot program~~ literacy instructional team members by school districts to which they were assigned, data on whether the ~~program~~ literacy instructional team members had an impact on increasing the number of students who demonstrate proficiency in reading, and recommendations for changes to the Strong Readers Act.

SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the Senate the 23rd day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

Passed the House of Representatives the ____ day of _____,
2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives